The Designer of:

Glossier.

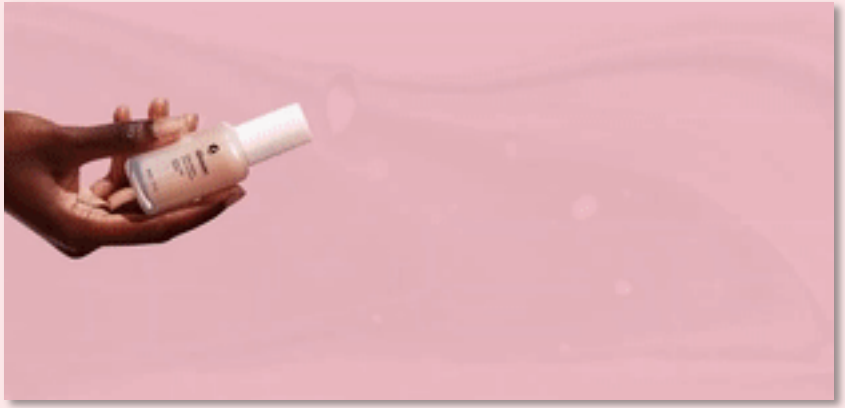
Adriana Deleo

What is “Glossier”?

Glossier **is a popular skincare and makeup brand started in 2014. It is targeted towards millennials and Gen-Z.**

It gained popularity during the 2010s, despite its minimalistic and natural products and branding in a time where heavy, full-faces of makeup were trending.

Coined the slogan, “Skin first, makeup second.”

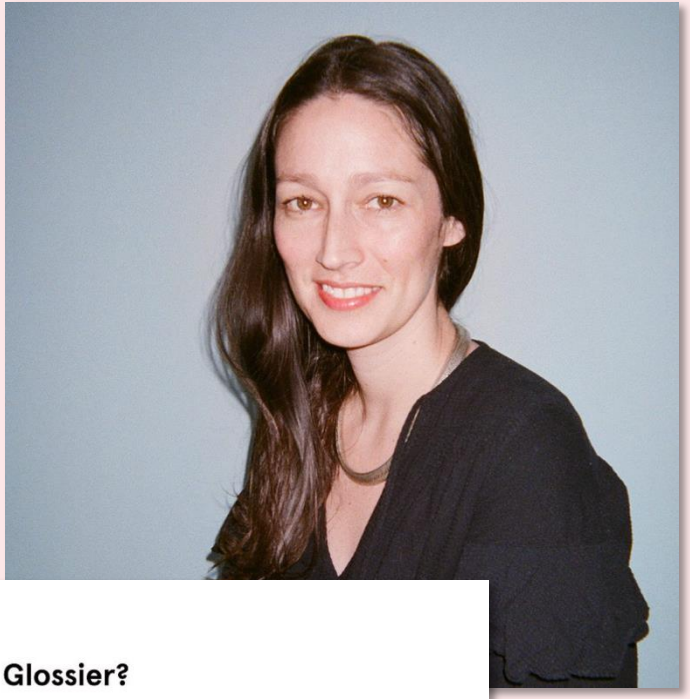


Singer Olivia Rodrigo as a *Glossier* ambassador.

The **natural** and near pharmaceutical look of *Glossier* challenged the **heavier, more dramatic** concepts of usual popular makeup trends and brands, such as *Nars*.

SKIN FIRST.
MAKEUP
SECOND.

Adriana Deleo



- **Role in *Glossier*:**
  - **Head of Brand Design**
  - **Vice President Creative Director**
- **Originally from San Juan, Puerto Rico**
- **Has a BFA in Graphic Arts from the Rhode Island School of Design**

What do you do for Glossier?

I head up Brand Design, which encompasses everything from our brand identity—typography, logos, and print collateral—to our packaging design and offline environments.

Deleo's Approach to Design

What's the Glossier approach to design?

There's a balance that we try to strike between the aspirational and the practical. We design with the real world in mind—and think about how something will look in your medicine cabinet more than on a store shelf.

Day to day, we are building brand guidelines and systems that will last into the future—and that part takes work to constantly refine, while listening to what is resonating with people. On the other hand, we also have fun with it and test how much we can stretch our brand. Like, how much can we get away with, while still being recognizably Glossier?

Deleo claims the *Glossier* approach to design is, "a balance between the aspirational and the practical."

The Brand and Product Design of Glossier.

“*Glossier* Pink”

Glossier.

The *Glossier* “G”

Typography:
Aperçu Bold Italic

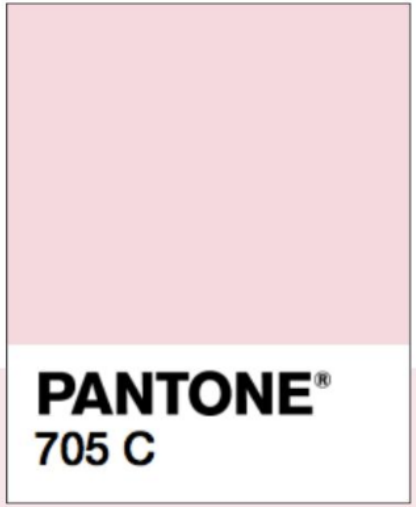
Alpha, Papa,
Echo, Romeo,
Charlie, Uniform

Packaging:

_colours

***also known as millennial pink**

705 C pale pink from the Pantone palette is our signature colour which we use throughout all marketing material. We compose it with white to create clean minimalistic (and Instagrammable) aesthetics.



RGB:	245 218 223
HEX/HTML:	F5DADF
CMYK:	0 11 3 0

_packaging typography guide

We always use lowercase on packaging (except for the wordmark).

We align text left.

All the product info is in black.

* Alternatively, if suitable, product name can be in a different colour.

product name:
Aperçu - Regular

product descriptor:
Aperçu - Italic

size (fl oz/ml):
Aperçu - Regular

“We could **get rid of all the copy…**and if we **just had that pink bar**, like, we own that so well that people would see that and say, ***‘Glossier.’***

- Designer, Dilan Walpola

Glossier.
priming moisturizer balance
oil-control gel cream
soin hydratant préparateur rééquilibrant
gel-crème séborégulateur
50 ml 1.7 fl oz

Glossier.
priming moisturizer
buildable hydrating creme
soin visage préparateur
crème hydratante modulable
1.7 fl oz 50 ml

Glossier. priming moisturizer
RICH
luxurious face cream
1.7 fl oz

the balm dotcom

the balm dotcom

“balm dotcom” is a universal salve that is *Glossier’s* most popular product, despite it being one of the simplest ideas ever (it’s glorified lip balm).

A representative product of *Glossier*, this packaging keeps the **same aperçu font in different variations**, also **relying on color** to communicate the uniqueness of each balm dotcom.

This rather simple design in its tube packaging is a testament to the **minimalistic yet trendy brand** that *Glossier* communicates to its audience.

cloud paint

cloud paint
seamless cheek color
blush aérien
STORM
TEAM
HAZE
DAWN
EVE
DUSK
DRIFT
WISP

cloud paint

“Cloud paint” is a liquid blush that comes in packaging that resembles a normal paint tube (such as acrylic paint).

Cloud paint keeps the same *Glossier* branding, typography, and minimalistic style whilst taking a creative approach to make it look like a tube of paint.

No other makeup brand has done a concept such as this.

lidstar

Lidstar is a liquid eyeshadow that can be blended out for a naturally washed-out look. (looks almost like nothing).

***Normally, eyeshadow is a pressed powder and its quality is based on its level of pigmentation, with higher pigmentation = better.**

Same iconic millennial pink on the cap, *Glossier* typography, and “g” on the product, whilst exploring creative bounds by going for a test tube look for an unconventional product.

“We have fun with it and test how much we can stretch our brand. How much can we get away with while still being recognizably *Glossier*?” - Deleo

packaging

Glossier. Gloss

@Glossier
#Glossier
SKIN FIRST.
MAKEUP SECOND.
SMILE ALWAYS.
COOL MOM PICKS

boy brow
grooming pomade
135
BLOND
Glossier.

pink pouch

A simple bubble wrap, Ziploc design combined with their iconic pink to create this bag that comes with every *Glossier* order and makes it easily recognizable.

sustainable, minimalistic packaging

"Sustainability has become a larger part of our process and has inspired us to evolve our material palettes..." - Deleo

Deleo's Advice for Pursuing a Design Career

Advice for someone who wants to pursue a design career?

Just keep working and making. You'll figure out your process and learn along the way. Plus the more you make, the less precious things become.

And be kind, stay curious, work hard, get a coffee with someone in a different "world" than yours, step outside your bubble...there's a ton of great ideas in unexpected people and places. As cheesy as it sounds, design is about connecting and being human, adding depth to the shapes and colors that make up a brand's graphic identity.

And the details are important! There's magic in the small gestures, both in design and life.

Glossier

Deleo advises that design has a humane quality in which it can evoke a sense of connection, emotions, and identity through graphic identity alone.

"Design is about connecting and being human, adding depth to shapes and colors that make up a brand's graphic identity."

"…details are important! There's magic in the small gestures, both in design and life."

Thank You!

Works Cited

https://issuu.com/oliwiadomorosla/docs/glossier_brand_book__single_pages_

https://intothegloss.com/2016/01/adriana-deleo-dilan-walpola/

https://www.instagram.com/glossier/p/B92Oc7Opp8U/?img_index=10

https://leslie-david.com/projects/glossier-branding

https://www.colophon-foundry.org/typefaces/apercu